

God's Judgments Are Sure and Just

When we first began the Born-Again Trail over a year ago, God pulled me into the Spirit and I looked down that trail in a milligram of a second by the gift of faith. What the human spirit can receive by revelation in an instant has taken me sixty hours to teach.

Before that visitation, He had been dropping verses into my spirit and preparing me. When He came that day, my faith was overridden by God's faith. The gift of faith is when God's faith comes on you, and doubt becomes ridiculous. You know that you know that you know.

While that was on me, I knew everything the Word promised me could be mine. Everything He called me to do, I knew I could do. He said, "It is all on this trail."

There was a rapport between my spirit and His Spirit. Anything my heart communed, He answered immediately. So I took advantage of that rapport to ask difficult questions I had carried for a long time.

I asked about the verses that seem to taunt us:

"The works that I do shall he do also;
and greater works than these shall he do."

And:

"Nothing shall be impossible unto you."

Those verses promise so much more than we usually see. Very few men in generations have walked in those things, and even some of them were later overtaken by the devil and discredited.

I said, "Those verses promise, but they do not seem to qualify us or show us how."

We had already dug out many keys: fasting, meditating the Word, praying in tongues. Recently He added the worship limb. But He said the answers I was looking for were in many of the verses we leave out.

Why do we leave them out? Because they are not the gung-ho verses that leave the flesh alone. We often live in doctrines of men, slicing off the piece of the pie that serves our goals and refusing the rest.

Imagine what could happen in a city if there were one master work that agreed with itself, full of love and compassion, large enough and spiritually forceful enough that the city had to reckon with it. But men slice truth into pieces and keep the part that serves their ambition.

When God added the worship limb, the first thing He emphasized was the difference between Old Testament worship and New Testament worship.

Jesus told the Samaritan woman:

"The hour cometh, and now is,
when the true worshippers shall worship the Father
in spirit and in truth."

Many have taught that "in spirit" means a state you attain through worship: you begin in the flesh, then the Holy Spirit assists you until you get "into the Spirit." That may describe experiences people have, but Jesus was speaking positional truth.

Just as Romans 8 distinguishes walking after the flesh from walking after the Spirit as positional truth, worship in spirit and truth means worship from a born-again human spirit.

The Father had sought such worship for four thousand years. A spiritually dead man could not enter the nature-to-nature, sonship fellowship that God longed for. But when the well of everlasting life springs up in the born-again spirit, the Father receives what He had been seeking.

This is why God kept me in the New Testament during the years I was assimilating it. Until I understood who I am as a born-again son, I would have used Old Testament examples in the wrong light, especially in worship.

Now when the flesh fights me in prayer and worship, I tell myself, "My Father has been looking for me for four thousand years for what I can give Him. I am staying here to fellowship with Him and worship Him."

Romans 2 says:

"There is no respect of persons with God."

That is one thing you can be sure of. God does not love one born-again child more than another. His love is sovereign. He cannot vary in degrees of love.

Then why are rewards different in heaven? Because of what we do with what we were given. We all came out of the gate with the same born-again experience in our spirits. Our soul histories may differ; some were lavished with love, and others were deeply damaged. But in the spirit, the same new birth occurred.

God fixed a place in heaven for every level of response, even complacency. He is your Father. But reward is not based on His favoritism; it is based on whether you take what He made you and conquer, or whether you barely respond.

Paul entered triumphantly after being beheaded. A man who repents on his deathbed enters as God's child too. God loves both. But Paul loved God more, and his reward reflects what he did with grace.

That kind of truth motivates you. It tells you it is up to you to respond.

Romans 2:13 says:

"For not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

This refers to the righteousness expressed in the Ten Commandments. No spiritually dead man could keep that righteousness. That is why animal sacrifices were offered: the blood kept them until the day of the new birth, but it could not purge the conscience from sin.

Romans 2:14-16 says:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law
written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while
accusing or else excusing one another;
in the day when God shall judge
the secrets of men
by Jesus Christ according to my gospel."

The Gentile who did not have the law receives a new nature and does by that nature the things contained in the law. The new nature becomes a law within itself. Nobody has to stand and preach the Ten Commandments to a born-again man for his conscience to know adultery, idolatry, lying, and false witness are wrong.

The new nature shows the work of the law written in the heart. The conscience bears witness. The thoughts are accused or excused by that witness.

Whatever my new nature accuses, I must not excuse. That is the standard by which we will stand before Him. What are you doing with the born-again experience?

This is one of the verses we often leave out, but it relates directly to power. If the promises of glory and power alone could motivate us, where are the people who have been motivated by them?

But when you get enough of these verses in you, you wake up in the morning and know whether your new nature is accusing your lifestyle. You can know, honestly in your heart, that you are trying to walk as a hard-working, moral person who loves God and will do anything He tells you.

The new nature does not replace the Word of God. It has the capacity to be taught the Word. But that new nature already has the moral law written in it. The Holy Spirit came as Teacher to teach this moral nature that has been freed from sin.

When I first began learning the Word, I wondered about the people before the cross. If I had understood that God is absolutely just and justified in judgment, I would have known He had provided a plan for them.

Romans 2:2 says:

"But we are sure
that the judgment of God
is according to truth
against them which commit such things."

That word "sure" belongs in the realm of sovereignty. We are absolutely sure that God's judgment is according to truth.

If you are going to do exploits for God, you must trust that He is just and His judgments are righteous according to the truth offered to every man. How can you have faith for a God you cannot trust?

I can have faith for my own son because I know God is just, justified, and no respecter of persons. I know Jesus healed him two thousand years ago. I know the covenant and born-again experience belong to him the same as they belong to me. God has one thing in mind: to give my boy's ministry and body back to him.

We were all sent out of the gate with the same born-again experience and the same God-given rights to healing, calling, and inheritance.

At the Great White Throne, God will speak for the last time to those whose names are written in the Book and those whose names are not. Hell and the grave will give up the dead. The universe will flee before His face. The elements will pass with fervent heat, and there will be a new heaven and a new earth.

In that final judgment, He will explain why He is just and justified. A just God would not send a person into final judgment without that person knowing why he is there.

You can rest assured that even the island or tribe you think never had visitation has had truth held before it in a way God will judge righteously. His judgment is according to truth.

You will see the one who deceived the nations, and you may be amazed: "Is this the one?"

When God cursed Satan to eat the dust of the earth, He reduced him in rank. The body of man is dust. Satan was cursed to operate below the level of the flesh, which means he cannot make you do anything you will not do.

Even the world must have its rulers and laws because unregenerated men, left unchecked, will destroy one another. History is dotted with conquerors who took what they wanted because they were stronger. The unregenerated man agrees to law, not because he loves righteousness, but because he does not want others taking his goods.

Satan was cursed beneath even that level. He cannot force your will.

Romans 1 deals with the fallen state of man, especially the world before the flood. It says the invisible things of God are clearly seen by the things that are made. Paul is not merely talking about admiring a tree or the Grand Canyon and concluding that God exists. He is talking about creation itself testifying against the fallen state.

Men did not want to retain God in their knowledge. Their foolish hearts were darkened. They worshiped creation, creeping things, and created things more than the Creator.

Then Paul targets a specific corruption:

"Even their women did change the natural use into that which is against nature: and likewise also the men, leaving the natural use of the woman, burned in their lust one toward another."

Creation itself testified that this was wrong. God eventually turned them over to a reprobate mind. That spirit is running rampant again, trying to take the world over.

If you want a picture of the early world, look at Sodom and Gomorrah. When the angels came to get Lot, the men of the city saw them as young men and wanted them. Even after the angels struck them blind, they groped at the door in their blindness, still trying to get in.

Do not toy with that spirit. It destroyed the whole world.

Lot tried to negotiate and offered his virgin daughters, which is horrible enough. But the sicker part is that his daughters were already married. Later they got their father drunk and committed incest with him. Lot's wife looked back, not in worship of God's righteous judgment, but because she did not want to leave that lifestyle behind.

Why did Ham's sin against Noah bring such a severe curse? The text says Noah woke and knew what his younger son had done to him. It was not a mere glance at nakedness. It was perverse.

God's judgments are severe because He is just.

You can rest assured that God's righteous judgment before the flood was just. Adam lived 930 years. Cain killed Abel, then fathered generations, and God eventually stopped recording that line in detail. But Seth was born to Eve, and when Seth was born, men began again to call upon the name of the Lord.

Seth lived 912 years. He fathered Enos, who lived 905 years. Enos fathered Cainan, who lived 910 years. Cainan fathered Mahalaleel, who lived 895 years. Mahalaleel fathered Jared, who lived 962 years. Jared fathered Enoch, who walked with God and was taken. Enoch fathered Methuselah, who lived 969 years. Methuselah fathered Lamech, who lived 777 years. Lamech fathered Noah.

These men overlapped one another for centuries. The gospel witness in that bloodline continued. Lamech died five years before the flood, and Methuselah lived until the year of the flood. Noah preached while building the ark.

From Seth's bloodline, men called upon the Lord, and God was not without witness. His judgment is according to truth.